KAAVI ART

Goa's oldest storytelling tradition, it is etched into its temples, churches and homes. The ancient mural art—made using a unique blend of lime and laterite—is native to the Konkan region and depicts mythological stories from the Ramayana and Mahabharata





Shri Saptakoteshwar Temple

Dedicated to Lord Shiva, it is considered to be one of the six great Shaivite temples in the Konkan region. Saptakoteshwar, a version of Shiva, was one of the chief deities of the kings of the Kadamba dynasty. It was built around the 12th century by the king for his wife Kamaldevi, a staunch Shiva devotee. According to folklore, Shri Krishna is said to have worshipped at the temple during the Dvapara Yuga. It is after worshipping Lord Shiva here that Krishna went on to establish his kingdom at Dwarka.
Where: Temple Road, Narve, Maem
Main event: Gokulashtami (Janmashtami)

Lairai Temple

Dedicated to goddess Lairai, who is believed to be an incarnation of goddess Parvati, the temple is a symbol of religious harmony, with local Hindus and Catholics regarding Lairai Devi and the Virgin Mary of Mapusa as divine sisters. The Lairai Temple Trail is at the heart of the folklore about the 'Seven Sisters and a Brother' who arrived in Goa riding an elephant. The temple trail consists of Lairai in Shirgaon, Kelbai in Mulgaon, Mahamayi in Mayem, Mirabai or Mirabalis in Mapusa, Morjai in Morjim, Ajidipa at Anjidipa Island near Karwar (no temple remains now) and the Shitlai who went to *pataal* (the netherworld) and has no temple dedicated to her. On the side of the temple is a 240-year-old painting of Devi in which she is depicted as a woman wearing a green sari within the confines of a *kalash* (sacred pot). The temple architecture is a combination of the northern and southern styles.
Where: Shirgao, Bicholim, North Goa
Main event: Lairai Jatra, also known as Shirgao Jatra, usually held in early May